



- ISO/IEC 42001 (AI Management System Standard)
- These provide ready-to-use checklists and guiding principles without cost.

Embed with current processes: To keep the process simple, just add AI/data policies into existing policies for HR, IT, or procurement policies. You may appoint an internal IT team member to check basic data quality and outputs of the AI model.

Define accountability of vendor/tool if using third-party solutions: If you are using third-party AI solutions, ask vendors about the source they use to collect the data, privacy protocols, model training process, and how they mitigate the bias. You can draft your own framework based on that information.

Ensure transparency: When integrating AI on your site, clearly mention the specific features powered by AI. Also publish how the customer's data will be used. Provide easy opt-out provisions for customers unwilling to share their data. This transparent approach will help gain the confidence of your customers.

Periodical auditing and updating: Review your AI/data policy on a half-yearly basis. Based on the latest versions or updates of the AI model, optimise the rules pertaining to fairness, privacy, relevance, and accuracy. Regular auditing can help evolve the policy with time.

Here are some use cases of how an SMB can benefit from regular reviews of its AI and data governance policy.

- If the algorithm in a food delivery app, which uses an AI-based model for recommendations, is set to push only high-margin items it will restrict the organisation's sales opportunities. Through regular auditing the algorithm can be optimised to include items across diverse price points, which will attract customers that have different budgets.
- A gym employing AI-based attendance analytics may discover that RFID data has led to an incorrect no-show report. When the flaw is revealed in periodical reviews, the gym can optimise the rule logic to ensure accuracy.

AI and data governance empower small businesses to adopt sustainable and responsible digital practices. While these enterprises may see this as unnecessary and complex, the reality is that data governance can strengthen their business. SMEs just need to draft a simple framework by leveraging the publicly available policies and moving in small but consistent steps. A well-drafted AI and data governance policy can help SMEs defend their organisations against vulnerabilities, avoid compliance issues, and ensure efficiency of their AI models. **END** 🐧

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